

Islamiat

HUM 4145/4137

“Basic Concept of Ibadah In Islam”

Topics to be Covered

- Introduction
- Definition
- What is Ibadah?
- The Concept of Worship in Islam
- conditions regarding Ibadah
- comprehensiveness and broadness of the meaning and implication of the term '*ibādah*'
- The comprehensiveness of "*ibadah*" for all aspects of this life
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- Why do we worship Allah?
- Where are we going? -The Purpose of Life
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Introduction

- In some religions, worship is a means to develop in man the attitude of asceticism and isolation from life. In these religions, it seeks to develop a mentality which anathematizes the enjoyment of the pleasures of this world.
- There are other religions which consecrate certain places for the sake of worship and prohibit its performance at any other place. There are also religions which are of the view that worship can be performed only under the leadership of a particular class of people—the ordained priests. People may, therefore, perform worship under the leadership of priests and only at the places consecrated for it. Thus the nature as well as the forms of worship differ from one religion to the other.



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What is Ibadah?

- The meaning of "*ibadah*" in the Arabic language is obedience, submission, and humility.
- The "*ibadah*" in Islam means: The ultimate obedience, the ultimate submission and the ultimate humility to Allah (S.W.T.) along with the ultimate love for Him.

Definition

- Ibn Taymiyah says, 'The word *'ibādah* is a noun that includes everything that Allah loves and accepts from saying and the physical acts; the hidden (acts by heart) and open (acts by limbs). The acts by limbs include *salāt*, *zakāt*, *sawm* and *hajj*, truthfulness, loyalty, kindness with the parents, having good accord with relatives, keeping promises, ordering what is good and forbidding what is evil, fighting against the *Kuffār* and the hypocrites, kindness with the neighbors, with the orphan, with the poor, with the wayfarer, with the animals, supplication, remembering Allah, reciting the Qur'an, and all things of this nature are from *'ibādah*. Similarly, loving Allah and His Prophet, fearing Allah and returning and/or repenting to Him, devoting the whole religion for Him, patience with His commandments, gratitude for His mercies, content with His rulings, trusting Him, hoping His mercy, and fearing His punishment and the like are among His *'ibādah*.

What is Ibadah?

- سورة الذاريات (The Winnowing Winds) - Surat Adh-Dhāriyāt

51:56

And I did not create the jinn and mankind except to worship Me.

وَمَا خَلَقْتُ الْجِنَّ وَالْإِنْسَ إِلَّا لِيَعْبُدُونِ ﴿٥٦﴾

conditions regarding Ibadah

From this definition of "*ibadah*", we realize that the "*ibadah*" in Islam must meet Three conditions:

1. It is done with utmost sincerity and devotion and with complete and absolute form. Allah said:

So whoever hopes for the meeting with His Lord let him work deeds of righteousness and associate none as a partner in the worship of His Lord.} [18:110]

The Prophet (saas) said "Indeed Allah does not look at your faces nor your wealth but He looks at your hearts and your actions." [Muslim]

Also there is the Hadīth Qudsī where the Prophet (saas) said that Allah said "I am so self-sufficient that I am in no need of having partners. Thus, whoever does an action for someone else's sake as well as Mine, will have that action rejected by Me to him whom he associated with Me" [Muslim].

conditions regarding Ibadah

Thus as Allah is the ultimate source of everything, He should be accepted as the Lawgiver. Only His law will prevail and laws should be legislated in line with this spirit. The otherwise is tantamount to shirk. Allah says in sūrah Al-Tawbah, verse (31), "They took their priests and their monks as their gods instead of Allah and also the Jesus, the son of Mariam. And they have not been ordered but to worship the one God. There is no god except Him. Glorious and high is He above what they associate with Him."

Adī Bin Hātim, who had been a Christian before accepting Islam, once came to the Prophet (saas). When he heard him reciting the above ayah he said, "O Messenger of Allah, but they do not worship them." The Prophet (saas) replied, Yes, but they prohibit to the people what is halal and permit them what is haram, and the people obey them. This is indeed their worship of them.

conditions regarding Ibadah

2. Another vital condition of worship is that it is correct and therefore acceptable to Allah. Our 'ibādah of Allah should be as He and His Messenger (saws) have commanded us. Allah says

O you who believe! Obey Allah and obey the Messenger and do not let your actions become nullified.} [47:33]

The Prophet (saas) has said "Whoever does an action which we have not commanded will have it rejected." [Muslim] and he (saws) also said "Whoever does an action in a way different from ours will have it rejected" [Abu Dāwūd - Sahīh].

Fudayl ibn Ayyaad, a taabi'ee, said regarding the verse {...that He may test you, which of you is best in deeds...} [11:7] , "The most sincere and the most correct" so those who were around him said "And what is the most sincere and the most correct?" He replied "Action, if it is correct but not sincere will not be accepted and action, if it is sincere but not correct will not be accepted until it is both sincere and correct. Sincere means that nothing but the Face of Allaah is sought and correct means that it is in conformity with the Sunnah."

conditions regarding Ibadah

3. When anything will be done in a moderate and balanced way, not committing any excess or extremism. This is why the Prophet (saas) asked Abdullah Ibn 'Amr Ibn Al-'Ās, when he was reported that Abdullah stands the whole night in night-vigil prayer and fasts the whole day, to:

Your Lord has a right upon you, your self has a right upon you, and your wife has a right upon you. So give and fulfill to every owner the share of their rights. ‘ (Imam al-Bukhārī, *Sahīh*)

*On another occasion, as Anas Ibn Malik reported, "A group of three men came to the houses of the wives of the Prophet (saas) asking how the Prophet (saas) worshipped Allah, and when they were informed about that, they considered their worship insufficient and said, "Where are we from the Prophet (saas) as his past and future sins have been forgiven." Then one of them said, "I will perform Prayer throughout the night forever." The other said, "I will fast throughout the year." The third said, "I will keep away from women and will not marry forever." Allah's Apostle (saas) came to them and said, "Are you the same people who said so and so? By Allah, I fear Allah and I am conscious of Him better than you; yet I fast and break my fast, I perform Prayer and sleep, and I (also) marry women. So he who does not follow my Sunnah (tradition) is not from me (i.e. not one of my followers). (Imam al-Bukhārī and Muslim, *Sahīh*).*

THE CONCEPT OF WORSHIP in Islam

- A comprehensive concept that includes all the positive activities of the individual. This of course is in agreement with all inclusive nature of Islam as a **way of life**.
- It regulates human life at all levels: individual, social, economic, political and spiritual. That is why Islam provides guidance to the smallest details of one's life on all these levels.
- Small story..... Defecate, Evacuate

Comprehensiveness of the concept of worship (IBADAH)

It is clear that the concept of worship in Islam is a comprehensive concept that includes all of the positive activities engaged in by an individual. This is in agreement with the all-inclusive nature of Islam, which regulates life on the individual, social, economic, political, spiritual, and all other levels of one's life. This minute attention to one's activities is the reason why the Qur'an and the example and sayings of the Prophet deal with all aspects of an individual's and a society's life.

As following these guidelines is an act of obedience to Allah, He considers them as acts of worship. This very positive attitude encourages individuals to follow the relevant guidelines and thus to bring about personal and social transformation. It also causes an individual to internalize the guidelines, for even if no one is watching him, he knows that Allah is watching him.

Comprehensiveness of the concept of worship (IBADAH)

- Islam requires us to submit our lives completely to Allah, as the Quran instructed the Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) to do:

"Say (O Muhammad) my prayer, my sacrifice, my life and my death belong to Allah; He has no partner and I am ordered to be among those who submit, i.e.; Muslims." (6:162-163)

- Without this comprehensiveness and broadness of the meaning and implication of the term '*ibādah*' this aforementioned verse of the Qur'an will conflict with another verse: 'Say: My prayer, sacrifice, life and death are surely for Allah, the Cherisher of the worlds'. Al-Qur'an, 6: 162

Comprehensiveness of the concept of worship (IBADAH)

- Seeking knowledge is one of the highest types of worship. The Prophet told his Companions that "seeking knowledge is a (religious) duty on every Muslim." He also said:

"Seeking knowledge for one hour is better than praying for seventy years."

Social courtesy and cooperation, when done for the sake of Allah, are also a part of worship. The Prophet (saas) said:

"Receiving your friend with a smile is a type of charity, helping a person to load his animal is a charity, and putting some water in your neighbor's bucket is a charity"



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The comprehensiveness of "*ibadah*" for all aspects of this life:

- Allah (S.W.T.) says in *surat Al-Ahzab*, (verse 36), what can be translated as, "It was never for a believer; man or woman, when Allah and His messenger make a verdict about some issue, that they will have the choice in their situation."
- In *surat An-Noor*, (verse 51), Allah (S.W.T.) says what can be translated as, "The saying of the believers, when they are called to Allah and His messenger to judge among them, is nothing but we heard and obeyed."

The comprehensiveness of "*ibadah*" for all aspects of this life:

- Also in *surat An-Nisa'*, (verse 65), what can be translated as, "No, by your Lord, they will not believe till they make you a judge in what went wrong between them, then they shall find no grudge within themselves from your judgment, and totally submit."
- Allah (S.W.T.) says in *surat At-Tawbah*, verse (31), what can be translated as, "They took their priests and their monks as their gods instead of Allah and also the Christ, the son of Mariam. And they have not been ordered but to worship the one God. There is no god except Him. Glorious and high is He above what they associate with Him."

The useful social activities are considered as "*ibadah*" to Allah

- If they were meant to be for the sake of Allah (S.W.T.). They are so many in the *Qur'anic* verses and in the sayings of the prophet (S.A.W.) among which: Solving problems between people, visiting the sick, helping the poor, removing obstacles (like rocks, fallen trees due to hurricanes, banana peels...) off the road, supporting the oppressed, having justice between two people, helping people in their needs, the good word, even treating the animals kindly, and all things of this nature.



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Making a living is considered as "*ibadah*" to Allah if the following conditions are met:

1. The work has to be allowed in Islam.
2. The work has to be accompanied by a good intention.
3. The work has to be performed with excellence.
4. The work has to be within the limits of Allah. So, there must be no room for injustice, disobedience of Allah or mistrust.
5. The work must not keep someone away from his *deen* obligations like prayer, Fasting,

WHERE ARE WE FROM?

- Allah (swt) created us for a purpose:
- Do you suppose that We have created you in vain? (*Qur'an* 23:115)
- I created jinns and humankind only so that they may worship me. (*Qur'an* 51:56)

BUT WHY DOES ALLAH WANT OUR WORSHIP?

- ✽ What is “worship” (‘ibadah)?
- ✽ How do we worship Allah?
- ✽ Why should we worship Allah?

WHERE ARE WE FROM? What is worship?

Worship of Allah involves:

- ☀ **BELIEF:** that we are absolutely, 100% creatures that are **grateful** and **dependent** upon a Creator who **controls** all aspects of our life, but who gave us **FREEDOM** in this world to fulfill a **RESPONSIBILITY**
- ☀ **PRACTICE:** living our lives in accordance to our beliefs



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WHERE ARE WE FROM?

Why do we worship Allah?

- ☀ Worship does not benefit Him.
- ☀ Allah (swt) tells us in the Qur'an:
 - ☀ He who **PURIFIES** his soul/spirit/self is **SUCCESSFUL** (*Surat al-Shams*)
 - ☀ (The one who is successful) remembers the name of his Lord and says his prayers. (*Surat al-A`ala*)
- ☀ Worshipping Allah (swt) leads us to:
 - Self purification,
 - Success,
 - Fulfilling the **GOAL OF LIFE** (more later)

WHERE ARE WE GOING?

The Purpose of Life

- ✱ Worship of the Almighty is done not solely out of fear of hell or desire for heaven
- ✱ Allah is worshipped because He deserves to be worshipped – whatever is with Allah is BETTER than what we can get *anywhere* else

WHERE ARE WE GOING?

The Purpose of Life

- ✱ Worship of the elite is done not solely out of fear of hell or desire for heaven
- ✱ Allah is worshipped because He deserves to be worshipped – whatever is with Allah is BETTER than what we can get *anywhere* else
- ✱ Imam Ali (a) said:
I have not seen anything except that I saw Allah with it, before it, and in it.



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Halal

- Halal is an Arabic term meaning “permissible”
- In English, it most frequently refers to food that is permissible according to Islamic Law.
- In Arabic, however the true is it refers to anything that is permissible under Islam



Haram

- In English, unlawful
- In Arabic, Any action forbidden by Allah in the Quran or by the Prophet. Any action against the spirit of Islam.





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- Jabir al-Jazairi, Abu Bakar, (2001), **Minhaj Al-Muslim: A Book of Creed, Manners, Character, Acts of Worship and Other Deeds**, Riyadh, Dar-Us-Salam Publications.

Download Link:

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مع السلامة
Thanks